ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** It secured the coast and sea trade	West coast defence
2	**(c)** failed to destroy Maratha resistance	Struggle continued
3	**(b)** supplied his own horse and equipment	Types of horsemen
4	**(a)** hills and forts helped quick raids	Terrain
5	**(d)** shift of real power to the prime minister	18th century
6	**(a)** Disunity and superior British organisation	Internal rivalry
7	**(b)** people felt a common identity	Language of the masses
8	**(b)** they lost leaders and troops	Heavy casualties
9	**(b)** creating a base in the south	Strategic depth
10	**(a)** accepted a setback to preserve strength	Practical diplomacy

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To prevent officials becoming powerful (1); To keep them loyal (1).	1+1
12	Used Marathi (1); Taught equality (1).	1+1
13	Mughal pressure under Jai Singh (1); Shivaji wanted to save his forces (1).	1+1
14	Hills made them strong (1); They controlled trade routes (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Marathi devotional songs (1); Spread equality (1); Shared culture united people (1).	1+1+1
16	Salaries (1); Transfers (1); No hereditary posts (1).	1+1+1
17	Safe base (1); Storage of food (1); Quick raids (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Western Ghats hills (1); Hill forts (1); Surprise raids (1).	1+1+1
18	Financed army (1); Gave claims to lands (1); Created resentment too (1).	1+1+1
	OR: European passes for ships (1); Marathas refused them (1); Angre challenged them (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Terrain (1); Forts (1); Guerrilla war (1); Navy (1); Result (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Disunity (1); British strategy (1); Weak leadership (1); Technology (1); Anglo-Maratha wars (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Salaried officials (1); No hereditary posts (1); Ashta Pradhana (1); Mughal mansabs (1); Comparison (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Origin (1); Forts (1); Angre (1); Cartaz (1); Trade (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** restored Maratha power in north India	Delhi 1771
2	**(d)** Hilly terrain	Western Ghats
3	**(d)** quick planning and cleverness	Strategy
4	**(c)** a pass required by European powers for ships	Challenged by Marathas
5	**(a)** concern for nature and people	Protected mango and jackfruit
6	**(c)** keep officials loyal to the king	Prevents a power base
7	**(c)** challenging European naval power	Naval skill
8	**(a)** women could lead armies and states	Strong personality
9	**(c)** To avoid local power centres	Control
10	**(b)** justice and temple-building	Good governance

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Maratha loss (1); It halted northward expansion (1).	1+1
12	Replaced Persian terms (1); Sanskrit seal and Marathi in records (1).	1+1
13	Extra revenue (1); Extended influence outside direct rule (1).	1+1
14	Allowed only teak cutting for ships (1); Forbade cutting mango and jackfruit (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Protect coastline (1); Safeguard trade (1); Block foreign ships (1).	1+1+1
16	Bajirao I led armies (1); Reached Delhi region (1); Controlled Malwa and Gujarat (1).	1+1+1
17	Fair justice (1); Temples and ghats (1); Care for subjects (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Showed Shivaji's tactics (1); Defeated Bijapur's army (1); Raised his fame (1).	1+1+1
18	Fought far from home (1); Loss of leaders (1); Abdali's strong forces (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Chiefs ruled regions (1); Peshwa was head (1); Shared power (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Need for legitimacy (1); Rituals (1); Title (1); Effect on followers (1); Effect on enemies (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Jijabai (1); Tarabai (1); Ahilyabai (1); Common qualities (1); Importance (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Sambhaji (1); Rajaram (1); Tarabai (1); Decentralised leadership (1); Aurangzeb's failure (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Modi script (1); Marathi (1); Temples (1); Thanjavur (1); Art and science (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** it brought revenue and links with other lands	Commerce
2	**(b)** adding to revenue without direct rule	Extended influence
3	**(b)** a scholar king of Thanjavur	Patron of arts and science
4	**(a)** He built a salaried, orderly system	Efficient administration
5	**(a)** It advised the king on different departments	Council of eight
6	**(b)** It preserved Maratha administration records	Historical sources
7	**(d)** Bred decentralised resistance	Marathas adapted
8	**(d)** chiefs gained strength under the Peshwas	Confederacy
9	**(c)** it was self-rule of the people of the land	Own kingdom
10	**(b)** Bajirao I - Peshwa	Famous Peshwa

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Both wanted control of India (1); British saw the Marathas as chief rival (1).	1+1
12	Weak later Chhatrapatis (1); Skilful Peshwas like Bajirao I (1).	1+1
13	Naval skill (1); Captured European ships (1).	1+1
14	Just rule (1); Public works and temples (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Treaty forced concessions (1); Agra visit meant dishonour (1); Escape restored his power (1).	1+1+1
16	Rebuilt power (1); Delhi in 1771 (1); Reformed army (1).	1+1+1
17	Jijabai guided Shivaji (1); Tarabai fought (1); Ahilyabai governed (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Rajaram, Tarabai and Shahu (1); Peshwas gained strength (1); Confederacy of chiefs (1).	1+1+1
18	Bargirs paid by state (1); Shiledars self-equipped (1); Mobile fighting (1).	1+1+1
	OR: British expansion (1); Maratha disunity (1); Succession disputes (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Role of Peshwa (1); Bajirao I (1); Conquests (1); Chauth (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Land revenue (1); Chauth (1); Trade (1); Agriculture (1); Ports (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Background (1); Battle (1); Losses (1); Effects (1); Recovery under Mahadji (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Early forts (1); Afzal Khan (1); Shaista Khan and Surat (1); Purandar and Agra (1); Coronation (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.